



PSYCHOLOGY (037)

TOP IMPORTANT & REPEATING TOPICS

PREPARED BY SARA THUNDERSTUDY

High-yield topics curated for Class 12 Boards based on recurrent examination patterns.

1. Theories of Intelligence and Aptitude

Core Focus Areas:

- **Arthur Jensen's Hierarchical Model:** Level I (Associative learning) vs. Level II (Cognitive competence).
- **Howard Gardner:** Theory of Multiple Intelligences (All 8 types).
- **Culture:** Technological Intelligence (Western) vs. Integral Intelligence (Indian tradition).
- **Creativity:** Terman's research and the non-guaranteed link between high IQ and high creativity.

2. Self and Personality

Psychodynamic & Post-Freudian:

- **Structure:** Id, Ego, Superego and Ego Defense Mechanisms (Projection, Denial, etc.).
- **Key Theorists:** Carl Jung (Archetypes), Karen Horney (Basic Anxiety), Alfred Adler (Inferiority Complex).

Personality Assessment:

- **Projective Techniques:** Rorschach Inkblot, TAT, and Draw-a-Person Test.

- **Type/Trait:** Sheldon's typologies and Eysenck's EPQ questionnaire.

3. Meeting Life Challenges (Stress)

The Stress Response:

- **Hans Selye's GAS:** Alarm reaction, Resistance, and Exhaustion stages.
- **Hardiness:** The 3 Cs (Commitment, Control, and Challenge).
- **Management:** Relaxation techniques, Assertiveness, and Stress management life skills.
- **Social Support:** Tangible, Information, and Emotional support.

4. Psychological Disorders

- **Anxiety/Somatic:** OCD, Phobias, and Somatic Symptom Disorder.
- **Neurodevelopmental:** Autism Spectrum Disorder and Intellectual Disability symptoms.
- **Diagnosis Models:** Diathesis-Stress model and Socio-cultural model of abnormal behavior.

5. Therapeutic Approaches

- **Cognitive:** Ellis's REBT (ABC Analysis) and Beck's Cognitive Therapy (Schemas).
- **Behavioural:** Systematic Desensitization, Token Economy, and Reinforcement.
- **Ethics:** Informed consent, Confidentiality, and Respect for rights.

6. Attitude and Social Cognition

- **ABC Model:** Affective, Behavioural, and Cognitive components.
- **Change Factors:** Source characteristics, Message content, and Target traits.
- **Prejudice:** Scapegoating, Kernel of Truth, and reduction strategies.

7. Social Influence and Group Processes

- **Social Loafing:** Why it happens and strategies to reduce it in groups.
- **Dynamics:** Tuckman's Stages (Forming, Storming, Norming, Performing, Adjourning).
- **Definitions:** In-group vs. Out-group; Differences between a Group and a Team.

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